
I Think I Know Why Melania Trump Really Just Went After Jimmy Kimmel

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Even those of us who don't consider Melania Trump a particularly sympathetic figure can concede that she lived through something traumatic this weekend. A shooter tried to assassinate her husband at the White House Correspondents' Association dinner, and [unlike previous attempts on the president's life](#), the first lady was there to witness it. There's no one right way to act after something like that happens; we all deal with trauma in different ways. But something tells me it would be difficult to find a single mental health professional who would endorse the path Melania has apparently chosen: calling for the firing of Jimmy Kimmel.

On Monday morning, the first lady posted a statement on Twitter accusing Kimmel of "hateful and violent rhetoric."

Kimmel's hateful and violent rhetoric is intended to divide our country. His monologue about my family isn't comedy- his words are corrosive and deepens the political sickness within America.

People like Kimmel shouldn't have the opportunity to enter our homes each evening to...

— First Lady Melania Trump (@FLOTUS)
[April 27, 2026](#)

If you're having trouble following the logic here—someone shot at her husband, Kimmel frequently makes fun of him, and therefore he must go—you're not alone. But before long, the president shared a statement backing up his wife [on Truth Social](#), and that actually helped to clarify things: Melania seemed to be referring to a specific bit Kimmel had done on his late-night show the Thursday before the shooting. In it, Kimmel pretended that he was the comedian headlining the WHCD, and it was edited with footage to make it look like Trump, Melania, and other guests were reacting to his jokes. "Look at Melania, so beautiful," Kimmel said during the fake address. "Mrs. Trump, you have a glow like an expectant widow."

The joke was a reference to the president's health—there have been a lot of questions recently about whether Trump is [mentally and physically fit enough to be in office](#). To imply Kimmel was calling for Trump's death, or using "violent" rhetoric, is a stretch, to put it mildly. You'll recall that this isn't the Trump administration's first tussle with Kimmel, whose weeklong suspension last year kicked off a free-speech outcry that even MAGA backlash couldn't withstand. What got him in trouble last time around were some comments he made in the wake of Charlie Kirk's murder. Perhaps punch lines about politics and death are not his forte. Even so, that Kimmel's jokes aren't always particularly funny doesn't change that he has a right to make them.

Watching the segment and comparing it to the first lady's reaction, the main thing I came away with was the thought that Melania is being her usual self, finding strange moments to air personal grievances. We last saw this on display [a few weeks ago](#) when the first lady made a surprise speech about how she had no relationship whatsoever to Jeffrey Epstein, a connection that was hardly top of mind for the vast majority of people but that Melania was nevertheless obsessed with refuting.

Though most of the commentary on Melania's Kimmel rant has pointed to the "expectant widow" line, it seems just as relevant that earlier in Thursday's show, Kimmel had been joking about Melania and Epstein. He was dwelling in particular on an infamous photo of the two of them together, as well as implying that it was Epstein who originally introduced Trump and Melania, a point the first lady was very specific in denying. Her lashing out and blaming Kimmel of all people for violence doesn't make much sense, but that's par for the course with Melania. At least she and her husband have found a common enemy for once. It's a somewhat rare display of unity. In her own messed up way, Melania Trump attacking Kimmel is both her grinding a familiar axe and letting her husband know she's with him.

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